PALAISDEFESTIVALEDIT

Travel Radio Australia, we're here in Cannes in France, and I'm very honoured to be speaking to Regis Four, who is the Director of Sales and Digital Projects at Palais de Festivals.com. You probably know it as the big place where all the stars are here, in May, I believe it's in May, yes, in May. The venue, it's with the famous red carpet. Regis, welcome to the program.

Yeah, thank you very much. Good morning, everyone. I'm very happy to have you here in Cannes.

Yes, it's such an iconic festival. We'll start with the film festival because that's what everybody knows around the world. It's basically a film festival for stars to promote their movies and the directors and the release people.

Tell us about that event, first of all, with the fabulous red carpet. Yeah, I mean, it's an amazing event known everywhere in the world. So, of course, there is the festival where you know all the stars coming every year in May, but there is also a market of movies where there are producers that are selling their movies.

So, there is a trade shows behind the festival. So, maybe people don't know that. That's a huge market we have here.

It's a little bit shorter. It lasts 10 days, but the film festival is 12 days, more or less. So, it's wherever I go in Europe or in the world, everybody talks about the film festival.

There's no Cannes. So, it's amazing for the city towards this event every year. And it's not only this event, you have another event in September called MIPCOM.

And that is really a great event because that's where all the movies plus TV series are bought and sold. And I tell people, because I've been to three MIPCOMs now, and I tell people that it's bigger than the Cannes Film Festival, more industry based. Yeah, exactly.

I mean, the film festival is really the biggest event we have, because it lasts longer. It's a B2B and B2C. So, but MIPCOM is very interesting.

So, you're right. I mean, a lot of people know the film festival. They don't know how many events we host every year.

We have big, big shows, trade shows like the MIPCOM. We have also ILTM. We have the Cannes Lions.

We have the MIPIM. There are leaders. I mean, the trade shows are leaders in their industry, the world during this event.

So, it's pretty amazing for a city like Cannes, which is a small village where only 75,000 inhabitants. But we have these huge events every year in the city. The great thing about Cannes is, because of these great things, outside of those festivals, the accommodation choice is fantastic in Cannes.

And it's very reasonable too. People think it's a millionaire's playground, but you can get great apartments on a weekly basis for very good money here. I used to call it a kind of district for mice, for the meeting industry, because we have the accessibility.

We have the airport, which is only 25 kilometers from here. We have, of course, as you mentioned, all the hotels, from three-star to five-star hotels. Of course, you know, Hotel Carton, Martinez.

But there are over a large range of hotels and apartments you can rent at different prices. So, there are prices for everyone, I would say. And the great thing is here in Cannes, you're so accessible by the rail station, the SNCF, to a bunch of other places like Arlo, Monaco, Saint-Tropez, Journe-Lepin, Antibes.

It's so handy to get around the area. Yeah, exactly. Well, Le Cote d'Azur is absolutely amazing.

I mean, of course, you mentioned the highways, but also highway. It's very easy to go to Antibes, Journe-Lepin, and even Monaco from here. So, it's very easy to get around.

So, what we see is that there are some business professionals coming for the shows, and they tend to arrive a little bit earlier because they want to enjoy the Cote d'Azur, to stay after the show, because it's such a nice place. It is a gorgeous place, and I've really got to know it very well, and quite a few of the local business owners here as well. And you have fabulous restaurants here.

I had dinner during the fabulous Lamom, which is really great. Tell us about a couple of those places. There is a lot of events.

We have also the Pan Beach. It's like an entertainment district. The owners have been waiting millions of euros for renovation a few years ago, and so you have, I think, five or six restaurants.

Of course, beaches, you have a night club. So, it's really a place amazing, but you have a large choice of restaurant on the Croisette, but not only also on the Suche, which is the old part of the city of Cannes. So, it's very authentic.

So, it's great. And I'd recommend something here, going up to Hilton, and having a drink up there where you get the panoramic views. And that's actually free to do.

You don't have to even be eating there. You can go up to the canopy on Hilton and do that. It's absolutely gorgeous.

Those beach clubs here, they're a really fantastic idea, and they're so popular with the hotels who have their own beach clubs, and people can visit those too. We have all this beach club, also part of the extension of the Palais de Festival, when we have, as you mentioned, the beach shows like Mipim, Mipcom, or even the film festival. I mean, they use the beaches to make brand, I mean, the companies to make brand activations.

And we saw it a lot with the Alliance, where each beach is more or less a brand activation. We have Spotify, Meta, Instagram, Pinterest, all the social medias are here, and it's absolutely fantastic. Especially during Mipcom, we've got all the major studios here.

We have Paramount, Netflix, Hulu, and they have absolutely massive stands here on the water. And some of those stands cost a million, two millions a week, right? Yeah, it's quite an investment, but the thing if they come every year is that they have some return on investment. So they meet people, they meet buyers, so I think it's worth investing.

But for instance, once again, the Alliance, there is also Amazon, that investing on the on the other side of the Palais, they are creating a huge village with concerts, and it's absolutely blowing. I walked in here with your press officer, and I actually got to walk through the here at the Palais de Festivals, the dressing rooms, where all the stars hang out, and it's before their shows. And that must be really special during the Cannes Film Festival to actually, you know, see all these incredibly famous people here in the building.

What is strange, sometimes you don't even recognize them, because you know, you see in all the movie theaters, and they are completely with their makeups. And sometimes you cross them in the elevators or in the, and you don't know who they are. So it's very, and you say, okay, well, for instance, last May I was in the elevator with Demi Moore, which was absolutely amazing.

It's a great experience anyway. I was going to ask about that. You must meet these incredible people being the, you know, the director here of sales and digital projects.

And these people, especially from Australia, we have tons and tons of world famous actors coming here. Did you meet anyone from Australia over the years? I think Nicole Kidman really features, yes. Yeah, definitely.

She was here. She was here. But we see, I mean, we see the world.

I mean, it's, it's amazing. In right in front of the Palais de Festival, you have this, this walk. It's a bit like in the Hollywood Walk, where the stars put their hands there.

And you've had into concrete, and you've had so many people there doing that. Exactly. So every year, because there's a film festival, but of course, we have other events like Cancérie, which is the festival of dramas.

When these actresses come here, we do these, these, these prints on the, I think it's agile or something like that. So it's, and then we, we show up and we, we, to the, to the general public. This weekend, there's the NRG Awards and Radio NRG, which is France's French radio, I believe, and fantastic event because some of the biggest music stars in France and around the world turn up.

It will be broadcast live evening. Yeah, it has been many, many years that we host this event in Cannes. It's part of, of the DNA of, of, of, of Cannes.

So that's why, I mean, for the last five years, six years now, we have been awarded the leading destination for festival events, which is absolutely great. Now, I also know that, and I'd recommend this to people, you have a little train, which is right outside the building here, and people can jump on that and go for an hour tour. That's a fabulous way to see the area.

Yeah, exactly. So you can go from the Palais and then to go to the, to the Palm Beach and, and go to the Sucre. And it's a nice, very nice way to, to, to discover the city.

In fact, so yeah, it's very easy to jump on and off. It's, it's very easy. And the trains here are great too, because you have those double decker panoramic trains and it's only like a couple of Euro to ride those trains to places like Gioin-Lepin, Antive, Saint-Tropez.

And it's very, very cheap to get around that way. Yeah, exactly. Though it's, it's quite cheap.

And it's well, we are very well connected with all the, the cities around, around Cannes. So, yeah. Well, thank you so much for being with us.

It's Regis Faur. And he is the director of sales and digital projects here at the magnificent building, Palais de Festivals.com. And you would recognize it from being on television and the red carpet, which, which also I'll point out, is open for people from anywhere to have their photos taken when there's not events on. Exactly.

Yeah. You can, you can take, and we see a lot of people coming every day to, to, to, to go on the red carpet. It's free.

So it's, yeah, I mean, people love this red carpet. So you can visit the Cannes Visitor Bureau office and you can have a free picture there of you with the stars in the background and the coat is your, and you, you identify. That's a great service.

Yeah, exactly. We have it at the tourist office. You can go, it's free.

I encourage you to come to the tourist office. There are a lot of ideas and, and advices for your travel when you are here in Cannes. Just before we go, the car marina is just magnificent.

And do you have some of the most expensive yachts in Europe there? Yes, definitely. And we

have also the, the most important yacht festival in Europe, which is in mid-September. So if you want to buy a yacht, you have to come mid-September in Cannes.

Lazy 50 million with you or something, you know. Maybe five would be enough. That's good.

And, and some of these yachts, they cost a lot just to tie up too, but they're great. Regis, thank you so much for being part of the program and for our French-speaking Australian listeners. Can you do a little welcome to, to Cannes in French for us?